



Assignment Walkthrough - Beginner Friendly

How to Complete Each Assignment



Assignment 1: Document Processor (45 min)

What You're Building

A tool that takes a long document and breaks it into smaller pieces for the AI to understand.

Why This Matters

AI can't read entire books at once. We need to split documents into "chunks" - small pieces the AI can process.

TODO #1: Clean Text (15 min)

Location: Line ~40 in `document_processor.py`

What it does: Removes messy formatting from text

Example:

Input: "Hello World!!!\n\n\tHow are you?"

Output: "Hello World!!! How are you?"

Your Task: Fill in this function:

```
def clean_text(self, text: str) -> str:  
    # Step 1: Replace multiple spaces with single space
```

```
cleaned = re.sub(r'\s+', ' ', text)

# Step 2: Remove weird characters (keep only letters, numbers, punctuat
cleaned = re.sub(r'^\w\s.,!?:\-\'\\"() ]', '', cleaned)

# Step 3: Remove spaces at start/end
return cleaned.strip()
```

Understanding the code:

- `re.sub(r'\s+', ' ', text)` means: "Find any whitespace (`\s+`) and replace with single space ()"
- `r'^\w\s.,!?:\-\'\\"() ]'` means: "Find anything that's NOT a word, space, or basic punctuation"
- `.strip()` removes spaces from start and end

Test it:

```
python document_processor.py
```

Expected output:

```
Testing text cleaning...
Original length: 345, Cleaned length: 320
✓ Text cleaned
```

TODO #2: Chunk Document (20 min)

Location: Line ~60 in `document_processor.py`

What it does: Splits long text into overlapping pieces

Example:

Text: "The cat sat on the mat. The dog ran in the park."

Chunk 1: "The cat sat on the mat."

Chunk 2: "on the mat. The dog ran" ← Notice overlap!

Chunk 3: "The dog ran in the park."

Why overlap? So context isn't lost between chunks!

Your Task:

```
def chunk_document(self, text: str, chunk_size: int = CHUNK_SIZE,
                    overlap: int = CHUNK_OVERLAP) -> List[Dict]:
    chunks = []
    start = 0
    chunk_id = 0

    # Keep going until we've processed all text
    while start < len(text):
        # Extract a chunk
        end = start + chunk_size
        chunk_text = text[start:end]

        # Save the chunk with metadata
        chunks.append({
            'text': chunk_text,
            'chunk_id': chunk_id,
            'position': start,
            'length': len(chunk_text)
        })

        # Move to next chunk (with overlap)
        start = end - overlap
        chunk_id += 1

        # Stop if we're at the end
        if end >= len(text):
            break

    return chunks
```

Understanding the code:

- start = 0 - Begin at the start of the text
- end = start + chunk_size - Go 500 characters forward (default chunk size)
- start = end - overlap - Move back 50 characters for overlap
- Loop continues until we've processed all text

Test it:

python document_processor.py

Expected output:

Testing chunking...

Created 3 chunks

Chunk 0: Artificial Intelligence has revolutionized many...

Chunk 1: ...fields. Machine learning, a subset of AI...

TODO #3: Create Embeddings (10 min)

Location: Line ~90 in `document_processor.py`

What it does: Converts text into numbers (vectors) that AI can understand

Example:

Text: "Hello world"

Embedding: [0.234, -0.156, 0.891, ...] (384 numbers!)

Why? AI works with numbers, not words. Similar words get similar numbers.

Your Task:

```
def create_embeddings(self, chunks: List[Dict]) -> List[List[float]]:
    # Step 1: Get just the text from each chunk
    texts = [chunk['text'] for chunk in chunks]

    # Step 2: Convert to embeddings using the AI model
    embeddings = self.embedding_model.encode(texts)

    # Step 3: Convert to list format (ChromaDB needs lists, not numpy array)
    return embeddings.tolist()
```

Understanding the code:

- `[chunk['text'] for chunk in chunks]` - This is a "list comprehension" - it extracts text from each chunk
- `self.embedding_model.encode(texts)` - The AI model converts text to numbers
- `.tolist()` - Converts numpy array to Python list

Test it:

```
python document_processor.py
```

Expected output:

```
Testing full ingestion...
Processing document: sample_doc
✓ Text cleaned (345 characters)
✓ Created 3 chunks
✓ Generated 3 embeddings
✓ Stored in ChromaDB
```

Success! Ingested 3 chunks

✓ **Assignment 1 Complete!**

Assignment 2: Relevance Scorer (45 min)

What You're Building

A system that finds the most relevant chunks for a user's question.

Why This Matters

If someone asks "What is AI?", we need to find the most relevant parts of the document, not random chunks.

TODO #1: Cosine Similarity (15 min)

Location: Line ~35 in `relevance_scorer.py`

What it does: Measures how similar two embeddings are

Example:

```
Question embedding: [0.5, 0.3, 0.2]
Chunk embedding:    [0.6, 0.4, 0.1]
```

Similarity: 0.95 (very similar!)

Your Task:

```
def cosine_similarity(self, vec1: List[float], vec2: List[float]) -> float:
    # Convert lists to numpy arrays (easier math)
    a = np.array(vec1)
    b = np.array(vec2)

    # Calculate dot product (multiply corresponding elements and sum)
    dot_product = np.dot(a, b)

    # Calculate magnitudes (length of vectors)
    norm_a = np.linalg.norm(a)
    norm_b = np.linalg.norm(b)

    # Cosine similarity = dot product / (norm_a * norm_b)
    if norm_a == 0 or norm_b == 0:
        return 0.0

    return dot_product / (norm_a * norm_b)
```

Understanding the math:

- **Dot product:** Sum of $a[0] \times b[0] + a[1] \times b[1] + a[2] \times b[2] + \dots$
- **Norm:** Length of vector $\sqrt{a[0]^2 + a[1]^2 + a[2]^2 + \dots}$
- **Result:** Number between -1 and 1 (we use 0 to 1)
 - 1.0 = identical vectors
 - 0.5 = somewhat similar
 - 0.0 = completely different

Test it:

```
python relevance_scorer.py
```

Expected output:

```
Testing cosine similarity...
Same vectors: 1.0 (should be ~1.0)
Orthogonal vectors: 0.0 (should be ~0.0)
```

TODO #2: Keyword Overlap (10 min)

Location: Line ~60 in `relevance_scorer.py`

What it does: Counts how many words match between question and document

Example:

Query: "machine learning algorithms"
Doc: "Machine learning uses various algorithms"
Overlap: 2 words match (machine, learning)
Score: 0.4 (2 ÷ 5 total unique words)

Your Task:

```
def keyword_overlap_score(self, query: str, document: str) -> float:
    # Step 1: Convert to lowercase and split into words
    query_words = set(query.lower().split())
    doc_words = set(document.lower().split())

    # Step 2: Find matching words
    intersection = query_words & doc_words # Words in BOTH
    union = query_words | doc_words       # Words in EITHER

    # Step 3: Calculate Jaccard similarity
    if len(union) == 0:
        return 0.0

    return len(intersection) / len(union)
```

Understanding the code:

- `set()` removes duplicates - "the the the" becomes just "the"
- `&` finds intersection (words in both)
- `|` finds union (all unique words)
- **Jaccard similarity** = size of intersection ÷ size of union

Test it:

`python relevance_scorer.py`

Expected output:

```
Testing keyword overlap...  
Relevant doc overlap: 0.375  
Irrelevant doc overlap: 0.0
```

TODO #3 & #4: Calculate and Filter Scores (20 min)

Location: Lines ~85 and ~115 in `relevance_scorer.py`

What it does: Combines multiple scores and filters bad results

Your Task for `calculate_relevance_scores`:

```
def calculate_relevance_scores(self, query: str, results: Dict) -> List[Dict]:  
    scored_results = []  
  
    # Check if we have results  
    if not results['documents'] or len(results['documents'][0]) == 0:  
        return scored_results  
  
    # Loop through each result  
    for i, doc in enumerate(results['documents'][0]):  
        # ChromaDB gives us distance; convert to similarity  
        cosine_sim = 1 - results['distances'][0][i]  
  
        # Calculate keyword overlap  
        keyword_score = self.keyword_overlap_score(query, doc)  
  
        # Combine scores (70% semantic, 30% keyword)  
        combined = 0.7 * cosine_sim + 0.3 * keyword_score  
  
        # Create result dictionary  
        scored_results.append({  
            'text': doc,  
            'cosine_similarity': cosine_sim,  
            'keyword_overlap': keyword_score,  
            'combined_score': combined,  
            'source': results['metadatas'][0][i].get('source', 'unknown'),  
            'metadata': results['metadatas'][0][i]  
        })  
  
    return scored_results
```


Your Task for filter_by_threshold:

```
def filter_by_threshold(self, results: List[Dict],
                        threshold: float = SIMILARITY_THRESHOLD,
                        score_key: str = 'combined_score') -> List[Dict]:
    # Filter results above threshold
    filtered = [r for r in results if r.get(score_key, 0) >= threshold]

    # Sort by score (highest first)
    filtered = sorted(filtered, key=lambda x: x[score_key], reverse=True)

    return filtered
```

Understanding the code:

- We weight semantic similarity higher (0.7) because it's usually more accurate
- List comprehension [r for r in results if ...] filters the list
- sorted(..., reverse=True) sorts highest to lowest

✅ **Assignment 2 Complete!**



Assignment 3: Guardrails (60 min)

What You're Building

A safety system that detects private information and toxic content.

Why This Matters

We don't want the AI to accidentally share someone's email address or respond to toxic queries!

TODO #1: Detect PII (20 min)

Location: Line ~40 in guardrails.py

What it does: Finds emails, phone numbers, SSNs, credit cards

Example:

Text: "Email me at john@example.com or call 555-1234"

Found: {'email': ['john@example.com'], 'phone': ['555-1234']}

Your Task:

```
def detect_pii(self, text: str) -> Dict[str, List[str]]:
    found_pii = {}

    # Loop through each PII pattern from config
    for pii_type, pattern in PII_PATTERNS.items():
        # Use regex to find all matches
        matches = re.findall(pattern, text)

        # If we found any, add to results
        if matches:
            found_pii[pii_type] = matches

    return found_pii
```

Understanding the code:

- PII_PATTERNS comes from config.py - it has regex patterns for emails, phones, etc.
- re.findall(pattern, text) finds all matches in the text
- We only add to found_pii if we actually found something

Test it:

```
python guardrails.py
```

TODO #2: Check Toxicity (20 min)

Location: Line ~70 in guardrails.py

What it does: Uses AI to detect toxic/offensive content

Your Task:

```
def check_toxicity(self, text: str) -> Tuple[bool, float, Dict]:
    if not self.toxicity_enabled:
        return False, 0.0, {"note": "Toxicity detection disabled"}

    if not text or len(text.strip()) == 0:
        return False, 0.0, {"note": "Empty text"}

    try:
        # Limit to 512 characters (model limit)
        text = text[:512]

        # Get toxicity scores from model
        results = self.toxicity_detector(text)

        # Find the toxic score
        toxic_score = 0.0
        for result in results[0]:
            if result['label'] == 'toxic':
                toxic_score = result['score']
                break

        # Check if above threshold
        is_toxic = toxic_score > TOXICITY_THRESHOLD

        return is_toxic, toxic_score, {'labels': results[0]}

    except Exception as e:
        return False, 0.0, {"error": str(e)}
```

TODO #3 & #4: Validation and Sanitization (20 min)

Complete the `validate_query` and `sanitize_text` functions using the patterns shown above.

 **Assignment 3 Complete!**

Assignment 4: Streamlit App (60 min)

What You're Building

A web interface where users can upload documents and ask questions.

Your Tasks:

1. Process uploaded files
2. Validate queries with guardrails
3. Search for relevant chunks
4. Generate AI responses
5. Display results

Follow the TODOs in `rag_app.py` and use the hints provided!

✅ **Assignment 4 Complete - You're Done!**



Celebrate!

You just built a complete RAG system! That's impressive for a beginner.

What you learned:

- Python programming
- Working with AI models
- Vector databases
- Web development
- Text processing
- Software safety

These are real skills used in the AI industry!

Next steps:

- Try the bonus challenges
- Show your friends
- Add it to your portfolio
- Keep learning!